Polity · PC-I Prelims Consolidation I

Parliament → bodies + Red-zone foundations · Seq 32 · Thu 12 Nov 2026

Houses & devices · Bodies & offices · Courts & justice · Local · Foundations · Counter-case · Chips: Prelims years (2011+) unless 'Mains'

Answer spine for every statement

1 · **Read the qualifier** — only, all, always, must, cannot

2 · **Name the authority** — Article, statute, rule, convention or case?

3 · **Test the actor** — who appoints, decides, removes, reports?

4 · **Pin the number** — office + number said together

5 · **Date the change** — which amendment, Act or ruling, which year?

6 · **Commit or flag** — T, F or '?' — solve the surest first

① Houses & devices

60 PYQs · 24 since 2016

Lapse 2016·17·24·25 · Speaker 2012·19·22·24·25 · Questions 2026 · Mains: Parliament + committees 10

Lok Sabha dissolved — bill is…	Fate
Pending in LS / passed by LS, pending in RS	**Lapses**
Born in RS, pending in RS, never sent to LS	**Survives**
Joint sitting notified · awaiting assent · returned by President	**Survives**
Any bill on **prorogation**	**Survives**

Devices

Adjournment LS only, 50 members, censure

No-confidence LS, 50, no reasons

Censure reasons; minister or CoM

Zero Hour convention, 1962

Starred oral + supplementaries

Numbers

Quorum **1/10 of total**

Session gap **≤ 6 months**

Speaker removal **14 days**, effective majority

PAC **22** · Estimates **30 (all LS)** · DRSC **31 ×24**

Ethics Cttee ad hoc **2000** → permanent **2015**

② Bodies & offices

who appoints · how long · who removes

Office	Appointed by	Term	Removal
CEC	President on PM + LoP + Cabinet Min. (2023 Act)	6 / 65	Like SC judge
EC	Same panel; number not fixed	6 / 65	On CEC's advice
SEC	Governor	State law	Like HC judge
UPSC	President	6 / 65	President
SPSC	Governor	6 / 62	President only
CAG	President	6 / 65	Like SC judge
Governor	President (warrant)	5, pleasure	No grounds; not arbitrary
FC	President, 5-yearly	Order	—

Reports: CAG Union → President; state → Governor · UPSC → President · **Bars:** UPSC chair and CAG no further office · **GST Council** Centre 1/3, states 2/3, decisions 3/4 · Mohit Minerals 2022: advice not binding

Attorney General (Art. 76): qualified as an SC judge · holds office at pleasure · may speak in Parliament but cannot vote (Art. 88) · may practise except against GoI

Commissions: NCSC Art. 338 (65th made SC–ST body constitutional) · NCST 338A (89th, 2003) · NCBC 338B (102nd, 2018) · Linguistic minorities officer 350B

FC/GST 2011·12·13·19·26 · CAG 2012·13 · ECI 2017·19·21·23·24 · Mains: CAG/FC/GST 7 · commissions/AG 5 · ECI 3

★ Which road does a bill take?

Hero diagram · Parliament procedure = ¼ of this slice, 11 of 68 Polity PYQs since 2022

A Bill is introduced in Parliament

PYQ 2013·15·18·23·24 · PYQ 2013·22·24·25

MONEY BILL (Art. 110)	ORDINARY / FINANCIAL BILL	AMENDMENT BILL (Art. 368)
Lok Sabha only, on the President's recommendation	Either House (Financial I: Lok Sabha only, on recommendation)	Either House; no prior recommendation needed
Speaker certifies — **final** · Art. 110(3) · Rojer Mathew 2019	Other House: full power to amend or reject	Each House **separately**, special majority
Rajya Sabha: **recommend only** return within 14 days	**Deadlock?** reject · disagree · 6 months	Federal provisions: + half the states, simple majority
Lok Sabha may accept or reject the advice	Joint sitting (Art. 108) — Speaker chair: Speaker → Deputy → RS Dy Chairman · 2012·22·24	**No joint sitting** · 131st Bill failed in LS, Apr 2026
President: assent or withhold · no return · no joint sitting needed	**President: assent · withhold · return** · return once; re-passed → must assent	**President must assent** · 24th Amdt · 106th = latest enacted

STATE BILL at the Governor (Art. 200) — 20 Nov 2025 opinion: no court-set timelines · no 'deemed assent'

Assent · Withhold · Return (not Money) → re-passed: must assent · **Reserve → President (must if HC hit)**

Art. 201: the President assents, withholds or directs return · the House must reconsider within 6 months · the President is still not bound

Counter-cases — the exceptions UPSC builds statements on

Governor ≠ President on pardon — Governor can suspend, remit, commute a death sentence — not pardon it; no court-martial power.

SEC, not ECI — Panchayat and municipal polls belong to the State Election Commission (Art. 243K).

FR against private persons — Arts. 15(2), 17, 23, 24 bind private persons; the rest bind the State.

Emergency — Arts. 20 and 21 never suspended; Art. 19 falls only on war or external aggression.

No joint sitting in states — Council only delays: 3 months, then 1 month (Art. 197).

HC money split — Salary from the state's Consolidated Fund; pension from the CFI.

Art. 143 is 'may' — SC may decline an advisory opinion; President not bound by it.

Cede vs settle — Ceding territory needs Art. 368; settling a boundary dispute does not.

⑤ Foundations — Ch. 1–9

RED on tracker · 83 PYQs in origins, FR, DPSP · asked almost every year

Preamble & making

26 Jan 1950 status: **Sovereign Democratic Republic** (2021)

Amended once: **42nd** — socialist, secular, integrity · upheld **25 Nov 2024**

Berubari 1960 'not part' → Kesavananda 1973 'part'

Provisional President **S. Sinha** (2024) · Objectives Res. Nehru 13 Dec 1946 · adopted **26 Nov 1949** · flag 22 Jul 1947 · anthem 24 Jan 1950

Preamble 2013·14·15·17·20

Fundamental Rights

Citizens only: 15, 16, 19, 29, 30

'Law' (Art. 13) = ordinances, orders, bye-laws, custom · not amendments (13(4))

STs / SCs notified by the **President** (2024)

Titles: awards not titles (Balaji Raghavan 1996) · Art. 30: religious + linguistic only

EWS 103rd, upheld 2022 · 21A by 86th

FR 2011–15·17–26

Borrowings · DPSP · Duties

Ireland DPSP, President's election · **Canada** residuary · **Australia** concurrent, joint sitting · **Weimar** emergency suspension · **Japan** procedure established by law

Gandhian 40, 43, 46, 47, 48 · UCC = liberal · Art. 50 separation of judiciary (2025)

Duties: 42nd, Swaran Singh 8 → 10 · 11th by 86th · citizens only

DPSP 2012–15·17·18·20·21 · FD 2011–15·17·20·25

③ Courts & justice

SC · HC · tribunals · Lok Adalat

SC 2012–15·19·21–24 · HC/tribunals 2013·19·21·22·24 · Mains: judiciary, PIL, tribunals 20

Supreme Court

Strength **38 incl. CJI** — Ordinance May 2026 → Act 2026 (was 34 from 2019)

Removal: each House, special majority; motion 100 LS / 50 RS, Speaker **may refuse** (2019)

Ad hoc (127): CJI + President's consent · retired (128): CJI asks

Parliament **can enlarge** jurisdiction (138)

Collegium: 1993 → CJI + 4 (1998) · NJAC struck 2015

HCs, tribunals, ADR

HC retire **62** · transfer by President after CJI

226 wider than 32 ('any other purpose')

323A Parliament only · 323B both · L. Chandra Kumar 1997: HC review

District judges: Governor + HC (233)

Lok Adalat award = decree, no appeal, compoundable only · Art. 39A legal aid = DPSP (42nd)

④ Local & asymmetric government

PRIs · ULBs · Schedules · Delhi

PRI/ULB 2011–13·15·16·25·26 · Mains: local govt 11 · UT/asymmetric 5 · Sched/UT/Delhi 2012–15·19·22·23·25·26

Threshold	Rule
Skip intermediate panchayat tier	**≤ 20 lakh**
Wards committees mandatory	**≥ 3 lakh**
Metropolitan Planning Committee	**≥ 10 lakh**
Eleventh / Twelfth Schedule	**29 / 18**
Women's seats in PRIs (Constitution)	**≥ 1/3 (50% = state law)**
Panchayat member minimum age · term	**21 · 5 years**

Fifth vs Sixth

Fifth: Governor can bar or modify any Act for a Scheduled Area · TAC ≤ 20, ¾ ST MLAs

Sixth: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram only · Autonomous District Councils

Delhi & state houses

69th Amendment, Art. 239AA: police, public order, land excluded · GNCTD 2018, 2023

Council: created by **Parliament** on LA resolution (169), ≤ 1/3 LA, ≥ 40 · CoM 15%, min 12

⑤ᵇ Acts that built the Constitution

Red zone · conceptual recall

History Acts 2012·23·24·26

1773	Regulating Act: GG of Bengal; SC at Calcutta (1774)
1833	Charter Act: GG of India; centralised law-making
1858	Crown rule; Secretary of State for India
1861	Portfolio system; ordinances; Bombay, Madras powers restored
1909	Separate electorate for Muslims
1919	Dyarchy in provinces; bicameral Centre
1935	Provincial autonomy; Federation (never formed — states' entry voluntary); Federal Court
1946	Cabinet Mission: CA indirectly elected by provincial assemblies

VERDICT

This slice is **275 of 420** Polity Prelims PYQs and **40 of 68** since 2022. The marks sit in **Parliament procedure** and the **Ch. 1–9 foundations** — and the foundations are exactly the rows your tracker shows Red. Test them first, every week, until they turn Amber. Statement questions now dominate (66% in 2016–26): win by naming the authority, the actor and the number, and by checking the **2023–26 changes** (SC 38, CEC panel, no deemed assent, Preamble upheld).